because a truly fulfilling marriage for him was only attainable in a climate of full personal freedom which at the time was a chimera for most Indians. As he explained to his friend, Raja Ram Shastri, he too was in the prime of his life with desires and longings which he wished to make known to someone.[5] But not without freedom. Bhagat Singh's determination not to get married is also confirmed by his niece, Virendra Sindhu.[6] Bejoy Kumar Sinha too confirms how on 1 April 1929, which was only a week before the Assembly bomb attack took place on 7 April 1929, the two of them were watching a group of young boys and girls playing in a Delhi park, when Bhagat Singh sorrowfully remarked on the tragedy of their lives, where amidst the beauty of life before them, they had to choose to die for their beliefs rather than to live.[7] When, therefore, in the face of unabating family pressure to marry, Bhagat Singh had left home in August 1923, he had done so leaving behind a letter in his father's office drawer reminding him that 'at the time of my sacred thread ceremony, when I was quite young, Bapu Ji (i.e. his grandfather) pledged me for the service of my country', a pledge which he would now honour.[8]

In fact, the Assembly bomb attack of 8 April 1929 is revealing in one very important respect which has been entirely overlooked. This is to do with his attitude to love. If he had been able to love, Bhagat Singh would have loved passionately. And, it would have been the love of a revolutionary. Initially, when the HSRA decided to have bombs thrown in the Delhi Assembly, Bhagat Singh was not in the frame, even though he had pleaded to go, given two other comrades in the organization who were presented to go. Sukhdev, who had not been present at the meeting where the decision was made, however, accused Bhagat Singh of ducking out because Sukhdev alleged he wanted to spend more time with a certain woman who held a 'fascination' for him. Hurt by this baseless allegation by one so close to him as Sukhdev, Bhagat Singh insisted that a meeting be immediately reconvened where he could be authorized to go on such an expedition. Had he not done so he would not have been arrested after the Delhi bomb blast and hanged as he was. After this meeting was done, he had a letter sent to Sukhdev on 5 April 1929 through Shiv Verma. In this he